

Spinny

Used Car Platform: India

Document Type	Product Teardown and Feature Proposal
Focus Areas	Registration City Mismatch and Hub Experience Gap
Author	Harsh Kumar, Product Analyst and Business Analyst
Data Source	9,582 used car listings from the Indian second-hand car market
GitHub	github.com/harsh112003/used-car-analysis

1,294+	2	3	6
Cars listed in Delhi NCR	Core problems identified	Buyer personas covered	Product recommendations

This teardown examines two critical product gaps in Spinny's used car buying experience. The first is the Registration City Mismatch problem, where buyers encounter cars they cannot register at their address without entering a costly and opaque broker process. The second is the Offline Hub Experience Gap, where inconsistent staff quality at physical hubs undermines the trust that Spinny's brand builds digitally. Both problems directly impact conversion, buyer trust, and retention.

Spinny is India's leading full-stack used car retail platform, operating physical Spinny Hubs across 30 plus cities. Unlike classifieds platforms such as OLX and CarDekho, Spinny inspects, refurbishes, and resells cars under its own brand, positioning itself as a trust-first alternative to the unorganised local dealer market.

The Indian used car market processes over 4 million transactions annually. A large portion of these still happen through unorganised local dealers who use informal practices for RC transfer, often registering cars under unknown third-party addresses and charging undisclosed fees. Spinny's opportunity is to own the organised, transparent end of this market.

What Spinny Does Well	Where the Gaps Are
200-point quality inspection on every car Fixed no-haggle pricing with full transparency 5-day money back guarantee on all purchases Home test drive available in select cities Standardised pricing visible before hub visit	RC transfer process is opaque and offloaded to buyer Hub staff quality varies significantly across locations RTO filter exists only at state level, not RTO-office level No RC transfer cost shown upfront on listing page No context handoff from app to hub executive before visit

Three distinct buyer archetypes were identified based on user research and data analysis of 9,582 second-hand car listings. Each persona represents a real segment of Spinny's buyer base and connects directly to one or both of the problems identified.

Persona 1: Rohan, 27, Gurgaon

Profile	Goals	Pain Points
Age: 27 City: Gurgaon (HR26) Occupation: Salaried professional, 2 years of work experience Budget: Rs 5 to 8 Lakh Preference: First-owner, automatic, petrol car	Buy a reliable everyday car registered in Gurgaon Avoid broker and RC transfer complications Complete purchase within 2 to 3 weekends of searching	Finds good cars on Spinny but realises they are DL-registered only at the hub visit Does not know what the RTO code on the card means until it is too late in the funnel Worried about hidden RC transfer costs and timelines

DATA CONNECTION

From the used car dataset: automatic cars command a 93 percent price premium over manual (Rs 9.0L vs Rs 4.7L median), yet both have equal listing volume of around 4,800 each. Rohan represents the largest growing segment of metro buyers who want automatic but are price-sensitive. The RTO mismatch hits this segment hardest because budget cars in the Rs 5 to 8L range are often older, cross-registered DL cars.

Persona 2: Priya, 32, Noida

Profile	Goals	Pain Points
Age: 32 City: Noida (UP) Occupation: Mid-level manager, 8 years of experience Budget: Rs 10 to 15 Lakh Preference: Premium used car, CVT or AMT automatic	Upgrade from current car to a premium used option Wants a Kia Seltos, MG Hector, or Skoda Kushaq Expects the hub experience to match the premium feel of the Spinny app	Hub visit feels inconsistent and passive, not premium Staff cannot always explain CVT vs AMT differences, which affects her confidence App builds high trust but hub visit breaks it, causing drop-off despite strong intent

DATA CONNECTION

From the dataset: MG holds a median resale price of Rs 14.1L and Kia holds Rs 12.5L, both sitting alongside BMW and Audi in the premium resale segment. This confirms that Priya's segment is active and growing in the second-hand market. Losing her at the hub visit is a high-value conversion failure.

Persona 3: Vikram, 45, Delhi

Profile	Goals	Pain Points
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Age: 45 City: Delhi (DL) Occupation: Senior professional, possibly relocating out of NCR Budget: Rs 25 to 40 Lakh Preference: Luxury used diesel, BMW, Mercedes, or Land Rover	Buy a high-end diesel car at strong resale value Understand the full picture before committing, including RC status and remaining life Know his options if he moves to a non-NCR city later	Old luxury diesel cars carry hidden DPF maintenance costs and odd-even restriction risk in Delhi NCR No transparency on whether RC can be cleanly transferred if he relocates outside NCR Spinny shows price but not the full cost of ownership or end-of-life risk for old high-end diesel cars
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DATA CONNECTION

From the dataset: diesel cars older than 10 years have a median price of Rs 5.2L versus Rs 2.5L for petrol of the same age, but diesel depreciation steepens sharply after 7 years. For luxury diesel specifically, Land Rover holds Rs 40L and Mercedes holds Rs 24.5L median resale, but these are skewed by newer models. An 8 to 10 year old luxury diesel in Delhi NCR carries compounding risks that no platform currently surfaces transparently.

When a buyer in Gurgaon opens Spinny, they select Delhi NCR as their region. The results show cars from Gurgaon hubs, Faridabad hubs, and Delhi hubs, all geographically nearby. However, geographic proximity and registration relevance are two entirely different things, and the product currently treats them as the same.

THE CORE PROBLEM

A car with DL (Delhi) registration and a buyer with a Gurgaon (HR26) address cannot simply complete the RC transfer at the buyer's address. The car must either be re-registered under a Haryana address, or the buyer must use a third party's address, which is a legally grey, costly, and stressful process. In the current unorganised market, local dealers promise to handle this using unknown third-party addresses and charge Rs 8,000 to 15,000 with zero transparency. Spinny currently does not surface this issue at any point in the buying journey.

User Journey: Where the Friction Hits

1

Opens the App

Buyer selects Delhi NCR as region and sees 1,294 cars listed.

2

Applies Filters

Sets budget, brand, and fuel type filters. No registration city filter is visible at the right level of detail.

3

Shortlists Cars

Finds 3 to 4 cars he likes. Notices RTO codes such as DL3C and HR26 as small chips on the card but does not understand the registration implication.

4

Visits the Hub

Books a test drive, travels to the hub, and likes the car. Purchase intent is high.

5

Friction Surfaces

Sales executive mentions the car is DL registered. Buyer realises he needs either a broker or a third-party address for RC transfer, at an extra undisclosed cost.

6

Drop-off or Compromise

Buyer either leaves without purchasing, which is a lost conversion for Spinny, or proceeds with anxiety and distrust, which results in a low NPS score.

Root Cause Analysis

Spinny's location model is built around hub geography, meaning where the car physically sits. However, the buyer's mental model is built around registration relevance, meaning where the car is legally registered. These two models are in direct conflict, and the product resolves this conflict in favour of hub geography, making registration an

afterthought that only surfaces at the hub visit.

What Spinny Already Has and Why It Is Not Enough

CURRENT STATE: RTO FILTER EXISTS AT STATE LEVEL ONLY

Spinny has an RTO filter in the Filter screen showing state-level codes: HR, UP, DL, CH, HP. This is a positive step but it solves only half the problem. The state of Haryana, coded HR, covers Gurgaon (HR26), Faridabad (HR51), Ambala (HR01), and Panchkula (HR03). A buyer in Gurgaon filtering by HR still sees cars registered in Ambala, which creates exactly the same RC transfer complexity as a DL registered car. State-level granularity is not sufficient for a buyer making a high-stakes purchase decision.

Feature 1A: RTO District-Level Filter

Upgrade the existing RTO filter from state-level codes such as HR and DL to RTO-office level identifiers such as HR26 Gurgaon, HR51 Faridabad, and DL3C Delhi. This gives buyers true registration-city relevance rather than state proximity. The data already exists on each listing. This is a filter UX upgrade, not a data problem.

Feature 1B: Plain Language Registration Badge on Car Cards

Replace or supplement the small RTO code chip on the car card with a plain language badge reading "Registered in Gurgaon" or "Registered in Delhi". Currently most buyers do not know what HR26 or DL3C means. Making the implication clear before the hub visit eliminates the late-funnel surprise that causes drop-off.

Feature 1C: RC Transfer Transparency Modal

When a buyer with a Gurgaon address shortlists a DL registered car, display a contextual information modal with a message such as: "This car is registered in Delhi. Transferring it to your Gurgaon address requires an RC re-registration. Spinny can handle this end-to-end for a transparent fee. Would you like to include this in your purchase?" This converts an opaque friction point into a transparent and monetisable service that Spinny can own.

Feature 1D: Luxury Diesel End-of-Life Transparency Card

For diesel cars older than 7 years, particularly in the luxury segment, display a dedicated transparency card on the listing page. This card should cover: estimated remaining years before odd-even or BS-IV restriction impact in NCR, likely DPF maintenance cost range, and whether the car can be cleanly re-registered in a non-NCR city. This directly addresses Vikram's persona and is currently unaddressed by any platform in India.

BUSINESS OPPORTUNITY

The current unorganised market charges Rs 8,000 to 15,000 for RC transfer through brokers with zero transparency and legal grey areas. If Spinny offers this as a paid, transparent, end-to-end service, it creates a new revenue stream while simultaneously building buyer trust. This is a direct differentiator from both local dealers and other organised platforms.

Success Metrics for Problem 1

Note: The following metrics are directional. Baseline data should be instrumented in sprint 1 before numeric targets are set. These are the indicators that matter, not assumed percentages.

Metric	Why It Matters	How to Measure
Hub visit to purchase conversion rate	Primary indicator of whether the RTO friction is removed before the hub visit	Track purchases per hub visit before and after feature launch

Drop-off rate after hub visit	Shows whether buyers are surprised by RC info at hub or informed beforehand	Tag drop-off reasons in CRM post-visit feedback
RTO filter usage rate	Confirms whether plain language labels drive more filter engagement	Filter click events in app analytics before and after label change
RC transfer service attach rate	Measures commercial viability of the new transparency service	Number of RC transfer service add-ons per cross-RTO purchase
NPS score post-purchase	Captures overall trust and satisfaction improvement across all three personas	Post-purchase in-app survey at day 7 and day 30

Spinny's brand promise is to make buying a used car feel like buying a new car: transparent, inspected, and trustworthy. This promise is delivered digitally through the app. However, the moment a buyer steps into a Spinny Hub, the experience is entirely dependent on the individual staff member they encounter. Based on personal experience visiting multiple hubs across Gurgaon and Delhi, the quality is deeply inconsistent.

PERSONAL OBSERVATION: ACTIVE SPINNY USER

At most hubs visited, staff members sat passively. There was no car walk-around, no discussion of engine condition, transmission type, road performance, or service history. The test drive was self-directed with no guidance. At one hub, the executive could not explain the difference between a CVT and an AMT transmission, which directly affects a buyer like Priya who is comparing automatic options. This stands in sharp contrast to one exceptional hub visit where the executive covered every detail proactively, and that visit resulted in the highest purchase intent.

User Journey: Hub Visit Experience

1

Arrives at Hub

Buyer arrives at the hub. May or may not be greeted. There is no structured welcome flow or buyer context available to the executive.

2

Assigned an Executive

Assignment is random. The executive has no visibility into what the buyer browsed, shortlisted, or their stated budget from the app.

3

Car Walk-Around

Quality is inconsistent. Some executives provide a full walk-around. Most stand silently while the buyer inspects the car alone.

4

Test Drive

The test drive is self-directed. There is no commentary on ride quality, NVH levels, suspension feel, or CVT versus AMT behaviour.

5

Questions and Answers

Buyer asks questions. Answer quality varies widely. Executives at some hubs cannot explain transmission variants or fuel type implications.

6

Purchase Decision

Buyer leaves with unresolved doubts. High drop-off even when app-based intent was strong before the visit.

Root Cause Analysis

Spinny invests heavily in the digital product but treats the hub visit as an operations problem rather than a product problem. There is no buyer-context handoff from the app to the hub executive. The executive has no visibility into what the buyer browsed, what they shortlisted, their budget, or their stated preferences. Every hub visit starts from zero, which is a significant missed opportunity to personalise the experience and convert high-intent buyers.

Feature 2A: Hub Executive Companion App

Build a lightweight internal mobile or tablet app for hub executives that pulls context from the buyer's Spinny profile before they arrive. This includes cars shortlisted, filters applied, budget range, and number of app sessions. This gives the executive a 60-second brief before greeting the buyer, enabling a personalised and consultative conversation rather than a passive one.

Feature 2B: Buyer-Facing Test Drive Checklist

Introduce a structured in-app test drive checklist that buyers can follow during the visit: engine sound check, air conditioning performance, suspension feel, infotainment responsiveness, brake feel, and CVT versus AMT smoothness comparison. This reduces dependence on executive quality and empowers buyers to self-serve the inspection, raising confidence regardless of staff quality at that particular hub.

Feature 2C: Post-Visit Feedback Loop

Send a short three-question in-app survey after every hub visit: Was the executive helpful? Did they answer your questions accurately? Would you visit this hub again? Tie executive ratings to hub-level NPS and surface low-performing hubs in real time, creating accountability without waiting for quarterly reviews.

Using an Impact vs Effort framework, Problem 1 features should be prioritised first because they address drop-off that happens before the hub visit, reducing wasted effort for both the buyer and Spinny. Problem 2 features require internal tooling and training investment but deliver longer-term brand and retention value.

Feature	Problem	Impact	Effort	Priority
1A: RTO District-Level Filter	P1	High	Low	P0: Do Now
1B: Plain Language Registration Badge	P1	High	Low	P0: Do Now
1C: RC Transfer Transparency Modal	P1	High	Medium	P1: Next Sprint
1D: Luxury Diesel Transparency Card	P1	Medium	Medium	P1: Next Sprint
2B: Buyer Test Drive Checklist	P2	Medium	Low	P1: Next Sprint
2C: Post-Visit Feedback Loop	P2	Medium	Low	P1: Next Sprint

2A: Hub Executive Companion App	P2	High	High	P2: Roadmap
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CLOSING THOUGHT

Spinny has built strong digital trust through inspection, fixed pricing, and guarantees. The next frontier is bridging the digital-to-physical gap: ensuring that a buyer who trusts Spinny on the app continues to trust Spinny at the hub and beyond. The two problems identified here are not edge cases. They affect every buyer who crosses an RTO boundary, every buyer who steps into a hub with high intent but leaves without a car, and every high-net-worth buyer considering a luxury diesel with unresolved end-of-life questions. Solving them is not just good UX. It is good business.